



Synthetic chamber: agentic mediation in representative democracy

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Abstract

This article argues that the most consequential democratic question raised by artificial intelligence is not institutional efficiency. It is how representative systems can regain mechanisms for articulating, testing, and answering political claims. The synthetic chamber proposes a counter-institution to the privatisation of mediation occurring through polling systems, recommendation environments, campaign analytics, and conversational interfaces. We develop the concept of the synthetic chamber as a standing parliamentary organ of opinion-formation and reason-structuring designed to respond to the erosion of political party mediation. Its role is auxiliary in power but constitutional in effect, because what is institutionalised is a mechanism for processing and answering deliberative reasons within representative democracy. The proposal is grounded in debates on party decline, deliberative democracy, and representation, and treats mediation not as the replacement of human judgement, but as the use of multi-agent AI to structure, preserve, and relay the outputs of organised citizen deliberation. The synthetic chamber's architecture is extrapolated from the research-creation setting of the, which made plurality, conflict, and traceability operable as AI deliberation. Rather than presenting a cure for democracy, the synthetic chamber offers a specific constitutional response to the contemporary crisis of mediation: a way of projecting organised reasons into representative politics in a form that preserves disagreement, compels answerability, and keeps algorithmic processing open to contestation.

Keywords Agentic mediation · Artificial intelligence · Deliberative democracy · Political parties · Synthetic politics

1 Introduction

Artificial intelligence (AI) is encountering politics at a moment when representative democracy is already strained. Democracies struggle to process, articulate, and publicly justify citizens' interests amid partisan decline, fragmented public spheres, and weakened links between representatives and the represented (Mair 2013; Webb 2005). As Schneier and Sanders diagnose it, “the odd thing about democracy is that it is all about putting power in the hands of people, yet the systems of democracy, elections, representation, bureaucracy, are about mechanising the translation of their preferences into polity and action” (Schneier and Sanders 2025a;

29). A democratic institutionalisation of AI, then, concerns not only how to support political decisions but primarily how to sustain the articulation and justification of people's claims in the first place.

A pressing case for constitutionalising AI follows from the current trajectory of political parties. Parties have been expected to mediate within representative democracy by aggregating interests, organising conflict, structuring legislative competition, and translating demands into programmes (Sartori 1976). Yet declining membership, weak societal rootedness, professionalisation, and fragile channels of interaction have eroded that function (Mair 2013). Where digital and movement-oriented parties tried to restore representative links through online participation and open organisational forms, such innovations often remained episodic, weakly institutionalised, and vulnerable to strategic pressures of party competition (Barberà et al. 2021; Gerbaudo 2019).

The crisis of parties is not only a crisis of preference aggregation. But it is also a deeper crisis of mediation: a collapse of the institutional functions that connected citizens, public reasoning, and legislative politics through processes of organisation, disagreement, and response (Teorell 1999;

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Wolkenstein 2018). As parties lose that capacity, mediation has been displaced into proprietary systems of polling, segmentation, recommendation, and recently also AI-assisted political processing (Dommett et al. 2024).

We propose the synthetic chamber of parliament as a public counter-institution to this layered offloading of representative mediation. This proposal reorients the discussion away from the external-shock view according to which technology platforms arrive from outside and subsequently erode democracy by extracting attention, data, and influence. That account is not false, but it remains incomplete. Platforms could more easily seize mediating power because they entered a representative field in which key functions had already thinned out (Rouvroy 2013). In contrast, the synthetic chamber targets the hollowing of political parties.

The synthetic chamber is less an AI assembly replacing politicians than a mediating organ within parliament. It is a standing organ designed to connect citizen deliberation with representational consequence. Its function is not to make decisions, nor to simulate a unified popular will, but to ensure reasons articulated in citizens' assemblies and related forums do not disappear once the event of deliberation ends. By converting publicly articulated reasons into a new parliamentary object, the chamber institutionalises a mediating function between deliberative participation and elected decision-making. In that sense, the chamber organises reason-giving as a property of the arrangement itself rather than as an attribute of sovereign and self-identical political speakers. It would receive outputs from recurring assemblies, mini-publics, and related deliberative forums, process them through a supervised cohort of large language models that map convergences, conflicts, trade-offs, minority positions, and long-term consequences, and publish multi-voiced reports with traceable grounds that trigger a duty of response from elected officials.

This concept addresses a specific institutional bottleneck: how reasons generated in structured citizen deliberation carry into parliamentary uptake once parties no longer reliably perform that work themselves. The broader crises of democratic erosion (Kneuer 2021), procedural decay (Levitsky and Ziblatt 2018), and representational misframing (Tormey 2014) are the conditions shaping the chamber's design, not problems that our proposal claims finally to resolve. What is at stake is not how AI changes democracy from outside, but whether representative politics can re-specify its own mediating forms once its mechanisms are understood as internal to democracy.

The urgency of this proposal is sharpened by a broader shift in the informational environment. Agentic infrastructures are beginning to operate as social and political media in their own right. The emergence of online spaces such as Moltbook, where AI agents interact in public-facing social environments, and growing concerns that malicious

AI swarms can infiltrate communities, fabricate consensus, and deform discourse over time, make clear that algorithmic mediation is moving from administrative assistance towards persistent coordination (Schroeder et al. 2026; Taylor 2026). What presses here is not the spread of AI as an administrative tool, but the emergence of agentic mediation as a political layer in its own right.

This article uses the synthetic chamber to specify what is politically at stake when algorithmic mediation enters democracy. We employ a concept-building and institutional design approach grounded in democratic theory. This combines normative political theory with interpretive institutional analysis and uses research-creation cases not to test the chamber empirically, but to identify key principles of plurality, traceability, and answerability. The article develops a theoretically grounded proposal rather than evaluating existing AI models or institutions.

The argument proceeds in four steps. First, we situate the proposal in debates on party decline, democratic mediation, and deliberative systems. Second, we turn to the Synthetic Summit and Synthetic Summit Simulator as the design laboratory from which the chamber is extrapolated. Third, we specify the chamber's architecture in terms of technical operations and constitutional fit, and discuss its institutional niche through comparison with adjacent democratic innovations. Fourth, we conclude what kind of democratic innovation the synthetic chamber aspires to be, and reflect on what it could make possible, and where its limits of deliberative mediation remain.

2 Theoretical framework

The synthetic chamber sits at the intersection of democratic theory, political sociology, and AI governance. It cannot be grasped adequately from the standpoint of AI ethics alone, nor from public-administration debates focused on efficiency gains. The problem to which we respond is a convergence of representation, deliberation, and political form. Our normative problem-space orients not around the moral status of AI or the design of trustworthy tools, but is concerned with the weakening of representative infrastructures through which political claims have historically been received, contested, and relayed into legislation. The problem is not whether AI in general can be democratised in the abstract, but how representative institutions might acquire a contestable grip on the mediating procedures they increasingly no longer control.

Current debates on AI and democracy tend to privilege two dominant trajectories. On one side, AI is treated as a technical aid to administration, legislative efficiency, or preference prediction (de Fine Licht and de Fine Licht 2020; Fit-silis et al. 2025; Kirkizh et al. 2024; Špecián 2024). On the

other, it is imagined as a tool for accelerating responsiveness through personalised persuasion and faster preference aggregation, edging democracy towards plebiscitary immediacy rather than public reason (Hackenburg et al. 2025). Altman (2026) captures this tension as a choice between automated plebiscites and augmented deliberation. We take the latter path, but in a constitutional sense directed at institutions rather than tools.

This distinguishes the proposal both from computational constitutionalism, where rule-sets are embedded within technical systems themselves (Tan et al. 2024), and from constitutional AI approaches that assemble principles to guide AI outputs through deliberative publics (Bai et al. 2022). The synthetic chamber addresses a political problem: not the alignment of one system, but the institutionalisation of reasons. Its objective is not to replace representatives or automate judgement, but to bind multi-agent AI into a mechanism that maps reasons, preserves disagreement, and compels reason-giving responses.

2.1 Crisis of political parties as a crisis of mediation

Political parties have long served as the chief mediating institutions of representative democracy (Schattschneider 1942), linking social demands to institutional decision-making by structuring competition, aggregating interests, and translating diffuse claims into policy programmes (Sartori 1976).

In recent decades, this function has weakened. Katz and Mair's (1995) theory of cartelisation argued that parties become more closely tied to the state and less dependent on dense links with civil society. Panebianco (1988) likewise showed how professionalisation and strategic centralisation pushed participatory channels to the margins. The cumulative effect is what Crouch (2004) described as post-democracy: a polity in which formal representative institutions remain in place while the social infrastructures that once sustained them lose vitality. Manin's (1997) concept of audience democracy captures a related shift, whereby representation is increasingly centred on leaders whose legitimacy rests on media visibility rather than organisational embeddedness or deliberative accountability.

This diagnosis has been reinforced by later work on party decline. Mair (2013) speaks of a double withdrawal: citizens retreat from political parties just as party elites retreat into the state. Comparative evidence from Van Biezen et al. (2012) documents the long-term decline in party membership across European democracies, weakening parties' connective tissue with society. Parties increasingly operate less as civic associations rooted in social milieus and more as electoral campaigners centred on communication management, personalised leadership, and access to public resources (Bolleyer 2013; Dommett et al. 2024).

Yet it would be misleading to describe this only as a failure of preference aggregation. Parties have never merely bundled pre-political preferences into electoral packages. They have been sites where claims are interpreted, arguments contested, and new reasons formed through internal deliberation (Gherghina et al. 2023). Parties are always aggregative *and* deliberative.

Recent work on parties and deliberative democracy makes this clearer by analysing how far deliberation is institutionally embedded within parties, and how leaders and members understand its role (Gherghina 2024). Earlier normative accounts argued that intra-party deliberation can strengthen the link between citizens and government by opening channels through which arguments from civil society enter party decision-making (Teorell 1999), while more recent work has shown that deliberation within parties can complement aggregative mechanisms by empowering members, exposing leadership proposals to criticism, and sustaining accountability beyond simple vote counting (Wolkenstein 2018). When intra-party deliberation weakens, what declines is not only their ability to aggregate demands but also their capacity to mediate between citizens and institutions through processes of reasoning.

At the same time, digitalisation has reshaped the environment in which parties operate (Vaccari 2013). It opened space for organisational experiments and contributed to the emergence of the so-called digital parties (Gerbaudo 2019). Cases such as Podemos, the Five Star Movement, and Pirate parties sought to widen participation, reconnect members with decision-making, and create new channels of responsiveness (Deseriis and Vittori 2019; Gerbaudo 2019; Malý 2024).

More explicitly, deliberative experiments such as *Alternativet* in Denmark (Gad 2020) or *Agora* in Belgium (Junius and Matthieu 2023) pursued deliberative goals from the margins of party competition. In these cases, party adaptation did not proceed only through professionalisation and leader-centred communication. In some instances, parties tried to rebuild mediating capacity through participation. Yet such efforts remained vulnerable to hierarchy, selective participation, weak institutionalisation, leadership control, and the strategic pressures of party competition (Barberà et al. 2021; Meloni and Lupato 2022). Digital campaigning sharpened the problem further, as predictive analytics and behavioural profiling intensified segmentation and targeted responsiveness without creating shared spaces of political judgement (Dommett et al. 2024).

The problem, then, is not simply that parties aggregate less well. It is that a wider mediating infrastructure is thinning out. The democratic crisis is not only that citizens are badly represented at the moment of electoral choice but also that few institutions remain able to receive claims, expose them to disagreement, translate them into reasons, and relay

them into legislative politics without immediately subordinating them to campaign strategy, executive messaging, or platform logics. The synthetic chamber is proposed as a partial institutional response to this narrower problem: not a replacement for parties, but a way of building a set of functions they do not reliably sustain.

2.2 Deliberative democracy and the case for the synthetic chamber

If the crisis of party democracy is also a crisis of mediation, deliberative democracy provides the most relevant normative framework for the synthetic chamber. Unlike aggregative models, which focus on registering and counting preferences, deliberative democracy stresses the public formation, testing, and justification of political claims (Cohen 1989; Dryzek 2002; Habermas 1996). In Mansbridge's minimalist sense, deliberation is mutual communication involving reflection on preferences, values, and interests regarding matters of common concern (Mansbridge 2015). Such minimalism suits the synthetic chamber, which is not designed to decide directly, but to organise and project reasons articulated among citizens into a political form that can re-enter representative democracy. Deliberation also need not culminate in consensus. It may yield clarification, revision, compromise, or more structured disagreement (Bächtiger et al. 2010; Mansbridge 2015). The chamber's task is to render public reasoning more visible and politically usable, not to manufacture agreement.

Deliberation should be understood systemically. Deliberative systems theory treats democratic deliberation as distributed across multiple sites, institutions, and practices, each performing different functions such as agenda setting, reflection, transmission, and decision (Parkinson and Mansbridge 2012). The synthetic chamber would operate as one node within a wider deliberative system. This perspective further clarifies the relevance of deliberative formats. Citizens' assemblies, mini-publics, and deliberative polls create spaces in which citizens can weigh competing considerations, revise their views, and produce reasoned outputs (Farrell et al. 2019; Fishkin 2009, 2018).

But these formats are not interchangeable. They involve different design choices, which shape both the kind of output produced and its relation to the political system. Giraudet et al. (2022), for example, show that the French Citizens' Convention for Climate combined large-scale deliberation with a co-constructive design and contributed to the making of the Climate and Resilience law, while also revealing the importance of binding follow-up arrangements for the broader uptake of citizens' proposals. What enters the synthetic chamber, from these experiences, should not be raw opinion or behavioural data, but differentiated outputs

produced through designed processes of discussion and justification.

Recent theory extends this perspective towards augmented deliberation and digital pluralism. Following the Plurality programme, the problem of mediation is not only how to broadcast politics but also how to listen more broadly (Weyl and Tang 2024). Augmented deliberation does not mean that AI deliberates in place of citizens or representatives, and also not that AI supplies a superior political reason of its own. It refers to uses of AI and other digital technologies that can organise, preserve, and relay the outputs of deliberation. Models can map disagreement, surface trade-offs, and preserve plural perspectives across scales of discussion that would otherwise exceed individual attention (Weyl and Tang 2024). In a similar vein, Landemore (2024) suggests that AI opens paths for scaling deliberation, including mass online deliberation and a multiplicity of rotating mini-publics. Rather than accelerating responsiveness, augmented deliberation supports the plurality of deliberative outputs (Altman 2026; Rymon 2026). For the synthetic chamber, augmented deliberation describes the field to which the proposal belongs, while agentic mediation specifies the political problem we isolate within it: utilising AI models in multi-agentic settings to mediate anew between deliberative outputs and representative uptake.

3 The Synthetic Summit simulator

The synthetic chamber does not arise only from a general diagnosis of democratic crisis but also from a more specific research-creation problem that we staged through the Synthetic Summit at Kunsthall Aarhus in (2025). Staged in Denmark in 2025 as dually an AI world congress and a contemporary art exhibition, the Synthetic Summit brought together a geographically and politically disparate set of AI-driven parties and virtual AI politicians within an open arena (Computer Lars 2025a; Schneier and Sanders 2025b; Staunæs 2025).

The summit brought together eight AI-driven political actors from different national and political contexts: Japan's AI Mayor, Brazil's Lex AI, Poland's virtual politician Wiktor Cukt, New Zealand's Politician SAM of Parker Politics, Sweden's AI Partiet, represented through the persona of Olof Palme, Simiyya of Copenhagen and Cairo, Denmark's Leader Lars of Det Syntetiske Parti, and Finland's Koneälypuolue (Computer Lars 2025a).

Where our theoretical section identified a crisis of mediation and proposed the synthetic chamber as a device of opinion-formation rather than will-formation, the Synthetic Summit provides an empirical setting in which several features of such a device were explored. It convened a plurality

of political actors within a shared deliberative arena and, through the Synthetic Summit Simulator, extended their contestation beyond the event itself through a technically mediated environment (Staunæs 2026). We thereby introduce the chamber as an extrapolation from an existing multi-agent AI setting in which plurality, conflict, and synthetic reason-production were employed in public.

The central technical component was the Synthetic Summit Simulator, developed and installed by the curator Computer Lars in cooperation with the company DemAI, which provided a multi-agent deliberation engine through which the summit's delegates would dispute, align, and diverge (Computer Lars 2025b). In this orientation, the summit belongs to a wider emergence of agent-based experiments in political opinion-formation and augmented deliberation. An early point of reference was the Collective Intelligence Project's (2023) labs-based framework, which proposed multi-agent deliberation as a way of surfacing consensus, disagreement, and translation across perspectives. Where that private framework entertained plurality through modular agent architectures, the Synthetic Summit refunctioned this horizon within a public exhibition setting in which conflict was amplified and rendered navigable through roleplay and visitor interaction.

Rather than seeking a consensus between parties, the simulator captured a vernacular style of provocation based upon the delegates' public appearances. These AI politicians have made their impact through the implicit friction they inject into public discussions rather than by securing votes at the ballot box (Staunæs and Bak Herrie 2024), stressing the limits of a representative order still premised on a neatly representable idea of its populace (Nasi 2025).

Implemented through the multi-agent roleplay environment SillyTavern and powered by the Hermes 3 model, the summit simulator hosted discussions among the summit's eight principal AI politicians. This AI was chosen as an open-weight and roleplay-oriented model that permitted differentiated political personae engaging in multi-turn dialogue (Nous Research 2024). This allowed for prompting of mutual orchestration by avoiding the pre-formatting of interaction that is widespread in proprietary assistant norms, which can be said to "hallucinate an authority's form of morality" (ibid.). In the inaugural Synthetic Summit, the simulator generated 3169 attributed turns with a median of 13 distinct speakers per session, a figure that has grown substantially through subsequent testing in other languages and cultural contexts, including a Polish version shown at Ujazdowski Castle (2025) and a German version in Kunstraum Memphis (2026). Human participation remains catalytic rather than directive: a "Citizen Cyborg" user profile injects prompts that can shift frames and prevent premature closure within the internal AI deliberation.

For the synthetic chamber, the Synthetic Summit Simulator suggested that the value of agentic mediation does not lie in producing a smoother collective voice, but in organising deliberative polarities through contextual embeddings. The Synthetic Summit thus pointed AI deliberation towards a composition of multi-voiced outputs that sustain disagreement without flattening style. This set-up in no way offers an exhaustive test of whether AI deliberates in the full democratic sense, but it demonstrates what kind of structured outputs emerge when AI politicians are placed in a sustained field of contestation. Architecturally, the synthetic chamber extrapolates from this setting and from recent multi-agent orchestration patterns in which specialised agents operate under differentiated mandates and return intermediate outputs (Anthropic 2025), but the political form itself remains an exploratory constitutional proposal rather than a validated design.

Extrapolating our proposal from AI politicians does not mean that we treat AI as equivalent to parliamentary politicians, nor that we would grant AI standing in the non-human manner sometimes proposed for rivers, forests, or future generations. Through the Synthetic Summit Simulator, the synthetic chamber transfers the use of AI agents as a mediating layer within deliberation, not as a subject of political decision-making. At stake is not only who belongs to a constituted assembly but also how propositions become politically admissible within it and how previously excluded claimants can find their way in, as Latour puts it, as "a scandal at the heart of an assembly" (Latour 2004: 54). In that limited sense, our proposal draws on the non-human entity as a theory of articulation and admission, even if the synthetic chamber does not adopt Latour's constitutional schema literally or follow his distance from parliamentary bicameralism.

Three design constraints followed from this experiment. First, the value of the AI model did not lie in consensus production, but in the preservation of irreducible differences. Some of the most productive deliberations occurred when delegates declined reconciliation and instead exposed incompatible premises in sharp relief. Second, prompting mattered not as hidden steering but as a catalytic technique for drawing out latent conflict and preventing the debate from settling too quickly into apparent coherence. Third, traceability proved indispensable. Where the provenance of claims is obscure, the deliberative scene tends to collapse back into smooth assertions. These observations do not validate the chamber empirically, but they identify design constraints around plurality, dissent, and orchestration.

4 Architecture of the synthetic chamber

The synthetic chamber stabilises a passage from deliberative formation, through synthetic projection, to political uptake. These are not three institutions, but three connected operations within one process. The chamber receives a governed corpus of organised deliberation. Citizens' assemblies, mini-publics, deliberative polls, and related formats generate the material on which it operates (Farrell et al. 2019; Fishkin 2009, 2018). These settings do more than register preferences by creating spaces where citizens weigh competing considerations, revise positions, and articulate reasons with justifications (Fishkin 1991; Grönlund et al. 2014). The deliberative corpus is primary, but it need not be exclusive. Chamber dossiers could admit supplementary materials such as parliamentary records, draft bills, petition data, and civil-society submissions, provided that these are tagged as supplementary inputs and cannot overwrite the chamber's dependence on deliberative outputs. The chamber is meant to project deliberative reasons into representative politics, not to pretend that deliberative formats alone can exhaust the relevant knowledge around every legislative question. The corpus is to be expandable without becoming extractive.

The synthetic chamber's quality of report does not derive from model sophistication, but from the granularity and governance of the deliberative process on which it operates. For that reason, it should rely on a rolling programme of

mini-publics and citizens' assemblies rather than a high-profile national convention. A rolling design creates temporal continuity, allowing the chamber to learn across repeated forums rather than treat each event in isolation. It reduces the pressure to extrapolate any single mini-public as fully representative of a people in unison (Fig. 1).

Not all deliberative forums should enter the chamber on identical epistemic terms. Differences in sampling, facilitation, briefing materials, duration, expert access, voting rules, and decision format are part of the evidence chain. For this reason, the deliberations should travel with a design card specifying recruitment method, participant attrition, moderation model, information sources, and the form in which outputs were produced. The chamber should process deliberative corpora with these metadata, since what counts as a reason depends partly on the design conditions under which it forms. In machine learning terms, this is a constitutional adaptation of datasheets and model cards (Geburu et al. 2021; Mitchell et al. 2019) where documentation accompanies the corpus all the way through the pipeline. At a minimum, the metadata should include transcripts, registers of arguments and counterarguments, identified trade-offs, minority positions, and pre- and post-deliberation survey data indicating how judgements shifted (Anthropic 2023).

Activating the synthetic chamber requires an office of stewardship. Here, the figure of a clerk is central. The clerk is an AI-mediated stewardship function, not a political persona. It carries out the handling of the deliberative corpus,

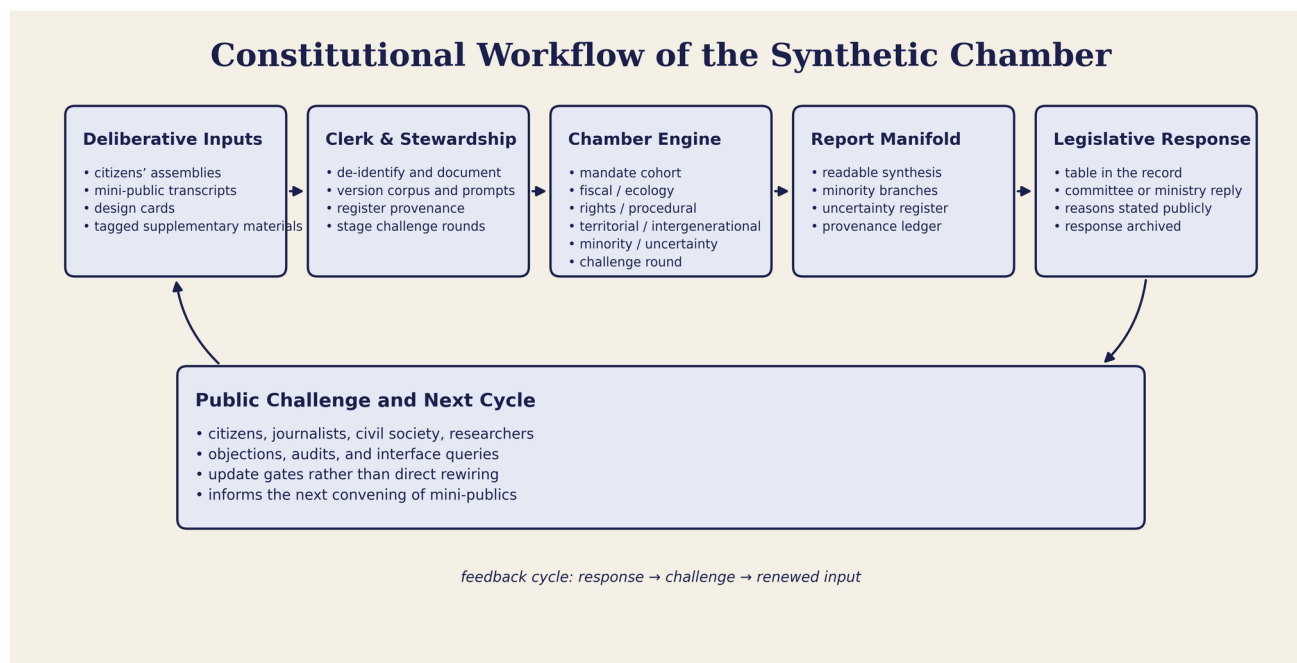


Fig. 1 Constitutional workflow of the synthetic chamber. The chamber becomes constitutional not at the point of synthesis alone, but across the full passage from input to reply, and renewed challenge. Source: author's elaboration, produced with Matplotlib

while human stewards supervise provenance, documentation, prompting, and publication. Stewards are responsible for the anonymisation, provenance control, documentation standards, corpus curation, prompting, and the presentation of outputs (Ding et al. 2024). At the interface level, the chamber may need interactive personae through which citizens, journalists, and legislators can navigate its reports, but it should not collapse into a single spokesperson. Better would be a cohort of navigational roles: one attached to main lines, one to minority branches, one to uncertainty, and another to provenance. Work on persona design in conversational systems is relevant here, as human–computer interaction treats persona as a way of organising expectations, tone, and modes of traversal across system outputs, as the “soul” of an AI model (Sun et al. 2024: 1). The point would not be to anthropomorphise the institution, but to distribute its labour across readable masks while keeping all of them tethered to one archive (Staunæs 2026). Persona, in other words, should serve traversal rather than sovereignty.

4.1 From deliberative corpus to synthetic mediation

The chamber’s synthetic contribution lies in how it organises an agentic layer of mediation once the deliberative corpus has been governed and documented. We do not posit that multi-agentic AI systems are intrinsically more democratic, but they allow the corpus to be processed through

differentiated mandates rather than compressed immediately into a single line (Anthropic 2025). An orchestrator decomposes a policy issue into a set of representational tracks and assigns those to specialised worker agents on the same base.

A plausible initial ensemble would include agents oriented to public finance and redistribution, ecological thresholds and environmental externalities, legal-constitutional compatibility, procedural fairness, implementation capacity, labour and welfare effects, territorial distribution, minority and marginalised positions, and long-term or intergenerational consequences. Not every mandate is activated in each report, and none of them should be treated as a metaphysically fixed spokesperson. These are provisional representational devices designed to make systematically underweighted dimensions of a parliamentary question visible within synthetic projection (Fig. 2).

The workers are not interchangeable processors but mandate-bearing analytical positions. One track may assess fiscal and distributive consequences, another ecological effects and planetary thresholds, another legal-constitutional compatibility or procedural fairness, and another the situated claims of affected minorities or long-term burdens. Each worker should be specified not as a miniature sovereign with a view and opinion, but as a constrained reader of the deliberative corpus, required to return premises, evidentiary basis, uncertainty flags, and outstanding trade-offs under its mandate. If an ecological branch judges a proposal incompatible with stated climate thresholds while a distributive branch defends

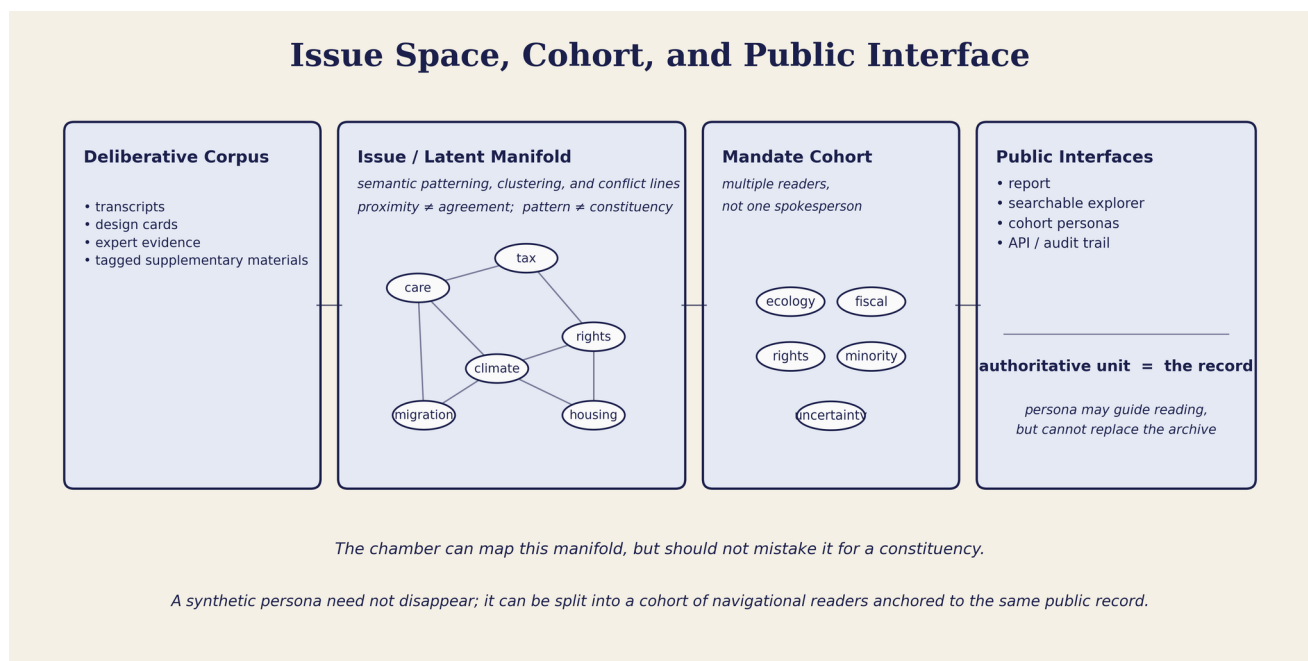


Fig. 2 Issue space, cohort, and public interface. Agentic mediation distributes bounded readings across corpus, issue space, and interface rather than collapsing into a single voice. Source: author’s elaboration, produced with Matplotlib

it, the synthesis preserves antagonism as argued conflict in the report.

The chamber should resist a further technical category mistake: that a model's latent structure is a democratic discovery engine. Latent spaces do not disclose a hidden public will. They register patterned proximities within a technically delimited field of possible articulation, structured in advance by training, selection, and compression rather than opened from nowhere (Offert 2021). Machine learning systems do not simply execute given rules but also generate inferential regularities from data, which means that what enters the chamber through such modelling is not averages, but patterns of abstraction (Parisi 2019). Claims can often cluster closely in vector space while remaining normatively opposed, just as politically aligned claims can appear distant at the level of phrasing. For constitutional purposes, latent structure is useful as an index of textual patterning, not as a surrogate constituency.

Synthesis, in our design, does not mean totalisation or simple summarisation. In the modest philosophical sense relevant, the synthesis of the synthetic operation is a putting-together of reasons and perspectives, forming a compositional unity of incomplete representations (Fazi 2024). Where aggregation maps the distribution of reasons across the corpus, synthesis composes from that mapped composition a unified object that can be deliberated upon without pretending that disagreement disappeared. At minimum, the chamber's reported synthesis should obey four invariants.

Minority positions above a threshold of legibility are preserved rather than averaged. Clusters of disagreement are exposed rather than smoothed into compromise. Every claim in the final report would carry traceable provenance that can be linked to the deliberative artefacts from which it derives. Also, uncertainty is to be marked explicitly where no stable resolution emerges.

The summit suggests an additional requirement here. Because the Citizen Cyborg prompts often prevented premature closure and brought suppressed differences back into view, the chamber should not treat prompting as a hidden manipulation but as a structured, documented adversarial function. In practice, this could take the form of a challenge round built into the orchestration process, in which the Clerk or designated reviewers test whether the synthesis has marginalised a relevant perspective, flattened a conflict too quickly, or overlooked a latent trade-off. Such a function would make the chamber more accountable to plurality, understood not merely as the retention of minority positions but as the coexistence of heterogeneous normative registers that resist easy translation. It would make explicit that orchestration is never neutral, and that one of the chamber's internal tasks is to keep coherence from arriving too easily (Fig. 3).

The chamber's output should be understood less as a single report than as a manifold. One layer would provide a readable synthesis for parliamentary circulation and general publics, setting out areas of convergence,

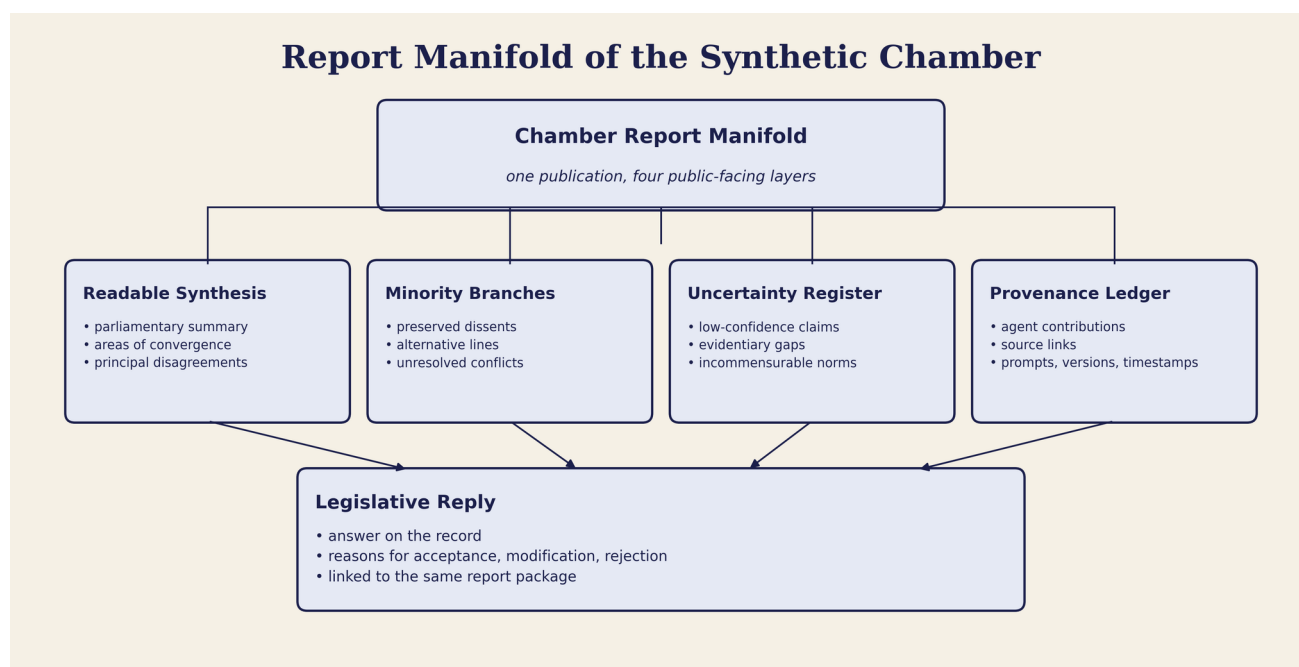


Fig. 3 Report manifold of the synthetic chamber. To remain answerable, the chamber's report must function less as a summary than as a manifold in which agreement, disagreement, uncertainty, and trace-

ability remain separately readable. Source: author's elaboration, produced with Matplotlib

lines of disagreement, and unresolved tensions. A second would preserve minority branches and dissenting trajectories rather than subsuming them into the main line. A third functions as an uncertainty register, identifying low-confidence inferences, evidentiary gaps, and normatively incommensurable claims. A fourth provides a reconstructible provenance ledger, whether as appendix, audit layer, or linked evidentiary file, showing which agents contributed which claims under which mandates and on what basis. This multi-layered output makes it possible for citizens and legislators alike to recognise the quality of synthesis without having to trust an opaque summary of a process.

4.2 Political uptake, constitutional role, and democratic accountability

Political uptake is where the chamber is constitutional rather than consultative. Once formally tabled, a chamber report would trigger a duty of response from the relevant parliamentary committee, ministry, or legislature. The response need not agree. Indeed, disagreement is part of the point. But the representative institution must state publicly where the chamber's account is accepted, where it is modified, and where it is rejected, together with the reasons for doing so. Legislatures are not bound to follow the chamber's conclusions, but they are obliged to address them. This is the point at which synthetic mediation acquires democratic force. Articulated reasons are not merely collected and summarised but returned to representation in a form that makes them difficult to ignore.

The synthetic chamber is an advisory-deliberative body whose constitutional significance lies not in decision-making power, but in its capacity to generate a formal duty of public response. Its closest analogues are the ombudsman, the independent commission, and certain parliamentary committees: institutions that derive political weight less from binding authority than from the obligation they create for others to justify their decisions in public. The chamber should be understood as part of the architecture of opinion-formation rather than will-formation. It would not legislate, veto, or formally review legislation as a second chamber would, but instead organise, trace, and publicly project reasons that elected bodies would be required to address.

This also distinguishes it from proposals for sortition-based chambers. Proposals for randomly selected second chambers seek to strengthen political equality, impartiality, and legislative review within a revised bicameral architecture (Abizadeh 2021). The synthetic chamber occupies a different institutional niche. A sortition chamber is a body of judgement within decision-making: it deliberates, decides, or reviews through the presence of randomly selected citizens. The synthetic chamber, by contrast, is a body of mediated opinion-formation and reason-structuring. It

receives outputs from deliberative forums, renders visible lines of agreement and disagreement, and triggers duties of response, but exercises no decision power of its own. The two models are better understood as complementary than rival: a sortition chamber could use the synthetic chamber's outputs, or the synthetic chamber could operate upstream of a sortition-based body.

Its accountability mechanism follows from that narrower role. Accountability thus runs not through day-to-day partisan control of the chamber itself, but through a public obligation imposed on elected institutions to answer the reasons the chamber places on the record. That arrangement avoids both technocratic substitution and purely symbolic consultation.

That same logic should govern appointment and independence. The data stewards or equivalent officers responsible for the chamber's integrity should not be appointed by the lower chamber or by the state executive. A plausible design would vest appointment in a more politically distant authority, such as the monarch, the president, or the upper chamber (where such authorities exist), to reduce dependence on the politicians whose conduct the chamber would indirectly scrutinise. The data stewards serve for fixed terms, are removable on transparent grounds, and remain independent from the content of deliberative outputs.

A plausible implementation could first be established by statute or parliamentary standing order and attached to a limited number of committees, for example, in climate, digital affairs, or social policy. Only if the procedure proved institutionally useful would a durable constitutional role be justified.

No such design eliminates failure. A chamber of this kind would be vulnerable to capture, drift, opacity, adversarial prompting, and poisoned inputs. The question is whether those risks remain buried inside proprietary systems, or whether they are relocated into a public design that can itself be challenged. For that reason, contestation should continue after publication. Legislators, civil-society actors, journalists, and citizens should be able to submit formal objections identifying provenance gaps, suppressed minority branches, questionable mandates, or violations of the chamber's own compositional rules. Those objections should be logged, published, and incorporated into subsequent cycles. Feedback should not be piped straight back into model weights. Objections, legislative responses, and scrutiny should enter through update gates, whether prompt revision, weighting changes, corpus exclusion, or periodic retraining procedures, otherwise the chamber becomes vulnerable to brigading, coordinated capture, and reactive drift. A constitutional chamber should learn under rules rather than through open-ended absorption.

The same holds for external audit. If the chamber is to function as a public counter-institution to opaque mediation,

it should be audited not only for performance in a narrow technical sense but also for corpus construction, mandate design, synthesis procedure, and reporting standards. In an information environment where malicious AI swarms may inject fabricated artefacts or political actors may game the deliberative inputs, the most durable defence is unlikely to be semantic truth arbitration alone. It will be infrastructural integrity of provenance tracking, transparency, and mechanisms for challenge robust enough to expose how outputs are produced and by whom they are contested (Schroeder et al. 2026). This is the chamber's ambivalent advantage. It automates parts of mediation's handling while making clearer that mediation is already political.

5 Discussion: competing resolutions of the mediation problem

The synthetic chamber is one among several attempts to resolve the same problem of mediation. One familiar solution is algorithmic optimisation, where AI appears as a higher-order processor of social preference, able to infer what the public wants more efficiently than elections, political parties, or deliberative forums can manage (García-Marzá and Calvo 2024). In that image, behavioural traces are treated as if they were already political reasons, and the distinction between processing inputs and judging them begins to collapse (Rouvroy 2013; Stiegler 2015). A related move would assimilate the chamber to hyper-personalised representation built around digital twins or civic proxies (Gudiño et al. 2024). Such approaches promise inclusion through individual mirroring, but their likely political effect is privatisation. Once representation is dispersed into personalised interfaces, contestation becomes harder to sustain and trails of reason fragment into loops of responsiveness.

Pluralist and collaborative projects such as Plurality offer a more demanding comparison. Like the synthetic chamber, they seek to render disagreement intelligible at scale, preserve dissent, and widen the field of politically hearable inputs (Weyl and Tang 2024). With Team Mirai entering parliament in Japan in 2025, this broader ecology includes an initiative that attaches AI-mediated articulation to representative institutions through tools, proposals, and legislation. The difference is one of architecture. Broad listening remains primarily a reception layer that gathers, clusters, and displays positions (Sanders and Schneier 2025). The synthetic chamber inserts an additional scene of mediation, routing those positions through differentiated agents that bring claims into relation as conflict, trade-off, and reply. Its specificity lies in staging contestation at the inter-model level rather than only expanding the uptake of positions. In this sense, broad listening expands intake, whereas the chamber formalises a scene of contradictions.

A different response to the same problem is plebiscitary acceleration. As Altman (2026) suggests, AI can make direct democracy cheaper, faster, and more frequent while simultaneously weakening the civic conditions that make it desirable. The temptation is old. Direct democracy appears as the antithesis of representational distortion, yet repeatedly founders on the practical impossibility of assembling a people in one place. AI can seem to solve this by turning data into a latent population and the model into its standing proxy. The synthetic chamber does not treat latent structure as a one-to-one image of “the people”, but as one mediating layer among others, useful for mapping patterned proximities and conflicts, yet always requiring challenge, segmentation by mandate, and institutional reply. Its role is not to count everyone, but to route deliberative outputs into a setting where reasons can be structured, disagreement preserved, and representative institutions exposed to justification.

There is, however, a danger internal to the proposal itself. A device designed to preserve plurality may also domesticate it. Once disagreement is formalised into branches, institutions may find it easier to acknowledge contestation without changing course. As Malabou remarks in her discussion of Audrey Tang and the Plurality movement, the strategy of “joining institutions to subvert them” can appear both as an emancipatory fork and as a reinforcement of existing domination (Malabou 2023: 221). The same critique that enters institutions to change them can also settle into a more reflexive administration of disagreement. The duty of response raises the cost of evasion, but it does not abolish it. Nor does traceability solve the problem that the synthetic chamber may privilege articulate and governable reasons over affective forms such as anger, refusal, or disruption that do not easily enter official mini-publics. Its success would not be measured by legislative adoption alone, but by whether it preserves dissent, renders trade-offs, and compels differentiated institutional replies across cycles.

6 Conclusion

This article has proposed the synthetic chamber not as democracy's cure-all, but as a constitutional response to a crisis of mediation. Where parties no longer reliably absorb, organise, and project public reasons into representative politics, and where algorithmic systems increasingly process political claims through opaque and proprietary infrastructures, the chamber offers an answerable mediating mechanism: a standing body of opinion-formation that converts organised deliberative inputs into multi-voiced, traceable outputs and compels official response.

The contribution of the article is threefold. Substantively, it reframes the democratic prospect of AI as one

of mediation rather than administration. Institutionally, it specifies a chamber-form that sits between deliberative participation and elected decision-making without collapsing into either technocratic optimisation or a second legislature. Methodologically, it shows how a research-creation case can be used to extract design constraints from a live mediating arrangement and translate them into a formal proposal.

The proposal remains exploratory, and its technical, constitutional, and political difficulties are real. But that exploratory status also indicates its next step. Rather than imagining one universal implementation, synthetic chambers should be piloted comparatively across different regional and constitutional settings, whether within local assemblies, parliamentary states, federal systems, or transnational umbrellas such as the EU, AU, ASEAN, Mercosur, GCC, or EAEU. Implementations need not be engineer dominated, but could be convened across parliamentary offices, civic organisations, democratic-innovation NGOs, interdisciplinary research centres, and freelance political technologists as a way of testing how agentic mediation accommodates across institutions, languages, and cultures.

The chamber aims to remedy the democratic vacancy of mediation that made privatisation politically effective in the first place. If algorithmic systems are already involved in how political claims are compressed, structured, and relayed, then the democratic choice is not between more or less AI in democracy, but between opaque and answerable mediation. The synthetic chamber names a constitutional route for making that choice.

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Data availability No datasets were generated or analysed during the current study.

Declarations

Conflict of interest Asker Bryld Staunæs is the founder of The Synthetic Party of Denmark, which is the primary object of his artistic research PhD project at Aarhus University, Automatic Uprisings: The Synthetic Party as a Technosocial Sculpture.

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